

SENATE BILL NO. 296

INTRODUCED BY M. YAKAWICH, C. NEUMANN

A BILL FOR AN ACT ENTITLED: "AN ACT ESTABLISHING AN ENHANCED PENALTY FOR A PERSON EMPLOYED OR VOLUNTEERING IN A CAREGIVING FACILITY WHO IS FOUND GUILTY OF AN OFFENSE AGAINST A VULNERABLE PERSON IN THAT CAREGIVING FACILITY; PROVIDING FOR "ALAN'S LAW"; AND PROVIDING DEFINITIONS."

BE IT ENACTED BY THE LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF MONTANA:

NEW SECTION. **Section 1. Short title.** [Sections 1 and 2] may be cited as "Alan's Law".

NEW SECTION. **Section 2. Additional sentence for offenses committed against a vulnerable person.** (1) If the provisions of 46-1-401 are complied with, an individual who is found guilty of an offense while employed or volunteering in a caregiving facility and who committed the offense against a vulnerable person in the facility in which the individual was employed or volunteering shall, in addition to the punishment provided for the commission of the underlying offense, be sentenced to a term of imprisonment in the state prison of not less than 1 year or more than 10 years, except as provided in 46-18-222.

(2) The imposition or execution of the minimum sentences prescribed by this section may not be deferred or suspended, except as provided in 46-18-222.

(3) An additional sentence prescribed by this section must run consecutively to the sentence provided for the offense.

(4) For the purposes of this section, the following definitions apply:

(a) "Caregiving facility" means:

- (i) a mental health facility as provided in 53-21-102;
- (ii) an assisted living facility licensed under 50-5-227;
- (iii) a long-term care facility, an adult day-care center, a mental health center, a medical assistance facility, or a nonprofit health care facility as provided in 50-5-101;

1 (iv) a community group home for developmentally disabled, mentally disabled, or severely disabled
2 persons that does not provide skilled or intermediate nursing care;

3 (v) a licensed adult foster family care home;

4 (vi) a halfway house operated in accordance with regulations of the department of public health
5 and human services for the rehabilitation of alcoholics or drug-dependent persons;

6 (vii) a youth foster home, a kinship foster home, a youth shelter care facility, a transitional living
7 program, or a youth group home as provided in 52-2-602;

8 (viii) a day-care center, a day-care facility, a family day-care home, or a group day-care home as
9 provided in 52-2-703; or

10 (ix) a public or nonpublic school.

11 (b) "Vulnerable person" means:

12 (i) a child;

13 (ii) a vulnerable adult as provided in 52-3-803; or

14 (iii) an incapacitated person as provided in 72-5-101.

15
16 NEW SECTION. Section 3. Codification instruction. [Sections 1 and 2] are intended to be codified
17 as an integral part of Title 46, chapter 18, part 2, and the provisions of Title 46, chapter 18, part 2, apply to
18 [sections 1 and 2].

19 - END -